The Reunion

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CHOSEN: THE STORY BEFORE THE MANGER

SCENE 8 — THE REUNION

Standalone song: approx. 3:10–3:25 (includes spoken sections)

CONTINUOUS FROM SCENE 7

Mary is still at Elizabeth’s home. She is calmer than when she arrived, but she is not healed.

She sits with a piece of cloth or another simple household task. Elizabeth is nearby.

Elizabeth notices someone approaching before Mary does.

Joseph appears. He carries the tool satchel Mary made for him.

ELIZABETH
Mary.

Mary looks up.

She sees Joseph.

For one instant, hope reaches her before she can stop it.

Elizabeth looks from Joseph to Mary. She understands that this conversation belongs to them.

ELIZABETH
I’ll be nearby.

Elizabeth exits without ceremony.

Mary and Joseph remain several feet apart.

Joseph does not rush toward her.

Silence.

THE REUNION

MARY
You came.

JOSEPH
Yes.

MARY
Why?

Joseph has rehearsed nothing useful.

JOSEPH
I was wrong.

Mary looks at him.

MARY
About which part?

Joseph takes the sting.

JOSEPH
About you.

Silence.

JOSEPH
You told me the truth.

Beat.

JOSEPH
And I didn’t believe you.

He does not qualify it.

JOSEPH
I’m sorry.

Mary does not immediately soften.

MARY
What changed?

WHAT CHANGED

JOSEPH
I prayed.

Mary waits.

JOSEPH
And God answered.

Mary understands before she wants to.

MARY
A messenger?

JOSEPH
Yes.

MARY
What did he say?

Joseph looks directly at her.

JOSEPH
That you told me the truth.

Silence.

JOSEPH
I believe you.

Mary has needed those words. They still do not erase what happened.

MARY
I needed you to believe me before an angel told you to.

JOSEPH
I know.

MARY
I needed you.

Beat.

MARY
And you left.

JOSEPH
I know.

MARY
Do you?

Joseph does not answer too quickly.

MARY
When Gabriel left, I was afraid.

JOSEPH
Mary—

MARY
No.

She steadies herself.

MARY
I was afraid of my family. The village. What people would say when they looked at me.

Beat.

MARY
But I still had you.

That lands.

MARY
I thought whatever happened... I still had you.

Beat.

MARY
And then I told you.

She looks at him.

MARY
And I didn’t.

Joseph has no defense.

JOSEPH
I’m sorry.

Beat.

JOSEPH
I don’t know what that felt like.

He forces himself not to hide behind an explanation.

JOSEPH
But I know I caused it.

JOSEPH TELLS THE TRUTH

MARY
Why?

JOSEPH
I wanted to believe you.

MARY
But you didn’t.

JOSEPH
No.

MARY
Why?

Joseph looks toward nothing, the life he had been so certain he could build.

JOSEPH
Because if I believed you... everything I thought I understood was gone.

MARY
Everything?

JOSEPH
The house.

Beat.

JOSEPH
The table. The life I thought we were building.

MARY
We were building it.

JOSEPH
I know.

Beat.

JOSEPH
And suddenly I couldn’t see what came next.

MARY
Neither could I.

JOSEPH
You still said yes.

MARY
Yes.

Joseph absorbs that.

JOSEPH
I was afraid of what people would say. What it would do to you. To us.

Beat.

JOSEPH
But underneath all of that...

He finally names it.

JOSEPH
I was afraid because I couldn’t fix it.

Mary sees him clearly.

MARY
You couldn’t control it.

Joseph looks at her.

JOSEPH
No.

Beat.

JOSEPH
And I thought if I couldn’t understand the road, there wasn’t one.

Silence.

THE COST HAS NOT DISAPPEARED

MARY
People are still going to talk.

JOSEPH
I know.

MARY
They’ll look at us.

JOSEPH
I know.

MARY
They may never believe us.

Joseph considers that honestly.

JOSEPH
They may not.

MARY
And you’re still afraid.

JOSEPH
Yes.

Mary is surprised by the answer.

JOSEPH
The messenger told me not to be afraid.

Beat.

JOSEPH
He didn’t tell me I would suddenly stop feeling it.

Mary recognizes her own journey in his.

MARY
No.

A small shared understanding.

MARY
He didn’t.

WHAT JOSEPH CAN OFFER

JOSEPH
I don’t know what this costs.

Beat.

JOSEPH
I don’t know what our life looks like anymore.

MARY
Then what are you offering me?

Joseph thinks.

Then, simply—

JOSEPH
Me.

Mary looks at him.

JOSEPH
I don’t have a plan anymore.

Beat.

JOSEPH
But I’m not leaving you to pay for this alone.

Mary lets the words reach her.

THE CHILD

JOSEPH
The messenger told me not to be afraid to take you as my wife.

Mary watches him.

JOSEPH
He told me the child comes from God.

Beat.

JOSEPH
And he told me that when the time comes... I will name him.

Do not say the name here. The public naming payoff remains protected for Scene 12.

MARY
And what do you want?

Joseph looks at Mary.

JOSEPH
You.

Beat.

His attention shifts not possessively, but toward the life Mary now carries.

JOSEPH
This.

He cannot quite name the size of it.

JOSEPH
Whatever this becomes.

Beat.

JOSEPH
I want to stay.

Mary searches his face.

MARY
Because the messenger told you to?

JOSEPH
No.

Beat.

JOSEPH
Because I choose to.

That distinction matters.

THE OLD PROMISE

A little silence.

JOSEPH
I told you something once.

MARY
You told me many things.

JOSEPH
I said whatever came... I'd walk with you.

Mary remembers.

MARY
You did.

JOSEPH
I thought I knew what "whatever" meant.

A faint trace of their old warmth.

JOSEPH
A leaking roof.

MARY
You would have fixed it before it leaked.

JOSEPH
Exactly.

JOSEPH
A bigger table.

MARY
Eight chairs.

JOSEPH
Maybe.

MARY
Eight?

The smallest almost-smile.

JOSEPH
Children who wouldn’t sleep.

Beat.

JOSEPH
Your garden dying because you refused to let me help.

MARY
My garden would have been fine.

JOSEPH
Of course.

For a breath, they are the young couple from Scene 2.

Then the truth returns.

JOSEPH
I thought I knew the road.

MARY
And now?

JOSEPH
Now I know I don’t.

Beat.

JOSEPH
But if you’ll let me...

He does not move closer.

JOSEPH

I’d still like to walk it with you.

MUSIC BEGINS

“STILL YOURS” — FINAL STANDALONE DUET

Song target: approximately 3:10–3:25; time the scene with the final track.

The spoken Middle 8 and hand exchange remain inside the song. Joseph offers; Mary chooses whether and when to take his hand.

[Intro]

[Verse 1: Joseph]

I had a road.

I had a room.

I had a table in my mind.

I had a roof

I meant to raise,

A future measured out in lines.

I held the plan so tightly,

I could not hear your pain.

When your truth stood at my doorway,

I shut the door again.

I cannot make them quiet.

I cannot make this right.

But I can stand beside you

Through the staring and the night.

[Verse 2: Mary]

You made me a promise.

I wore it like a shawl.

When the whispers found my window,

I had nothing warm at all.

I carried heaven’s answer

And watched your face turn cold.

You waited for an angel

When you had me to hold.

I do not need a hero.

I do not need a shield.

I need truth that stays beside me

When the whole town knows what’s real.

[Chorus: Joseph, Mary, Both]

Joseph

Still, still yours,

If you’ll let me be.

Mary

Still, still mine?

Can I believe what I see?

Both

Not the house we imagined,

Not the life we rehearsed,

But a hand can be offered

Where a heart has been hurt.

Joseph

I am still here.

Mary

Still here.

Both

Still yours.

[Middle 8: spoken call and response]

Joseph

I won’t speak over you.

Mary

Then don’t.

Joseph

I won’t stand in front of you.

Mary

Then stand close.

Joseph

I won’t answer for you.

Mary

Then listen.

Joseph

I won’t carry this for you.

Mary

You can’t.

Joseph

But I can carry it with you.

Mary

Then stay.

Joseph

I’ll stay.

[Bridge: spoken hand exchange, then sung]

Joseph

Here is my hand.

Only if you want it.

Mary

Leave it there.

Let me come to it.

Joseph

I will not take.

Mary

I will not hide.

STAGING: Joseph extends his hand without approaching. Mary looks at it and at him. She chooses to take it. Let the moment breathe.

Both

Love is not the road we pictured.

Love is choosing side by side.

[Final Chorus]

Both

Still, still yours,

With the whispers at the door.

Still, still yours,

Not the way we were before.

Not the house we imagined,

Not the life we rehearsed,

But a hand can be offered

Where a heart has been hurt.

Mary

Not because it’s easy.

Joseph

Not because it’s clear.

Both

But because we choose it

Here.

[Break]

Joseph

Whatever comes...

Mary

Whatever comes...

Both

We’ll walk together.

Hand in hand,

Breath by breath,

Still afraid,

Still unsure,

Still I choose you.

Still yours.

[Tag]

Joseph

Still yours.

Mary

Still yours.

Both

Still yours.

Music resolves warmly, with the choice to walk together carrying into the spoken ending.

AFTER THE SONG

They remain together for a breath.

MARY
So what happens now?

Joseph looks toward the road back to Nazareth.

JOSEPH
We go home.

Mary knows what “home” means now.

MARY
They’re going to talk.

JOSEPH
Definitely.

Mary almost laughs.

Then—

MARY
Together?

Joseph looks at her.

JOSEPH
Together.

They begin walking side by side.

TRANSITION INTO SCENE 9

No haze. No ominous lighting cue.

The familiar Nazareth marketplace ambience from Scene 1 begins to return.

For a moment, it sounds exactly like home.

Then Mary and Joseph enter the edge of that world.

One conversation stops.

Someone looks.

Another person looks away.

Mary’s hand tightens around Joseph’s.

Joseph answers the pressure with his own.

Neither lets go.

They keep walking.

END SCENE 8